
Hands-On Lab: AWS Compute Optimizer for EC2 and EBS

Objective

Enable **AWS Compute Optimizer**, analyze your EC2/EBS resource usage, and review **cost-saving recommendations** to right-size infrastructure.

Prerequisites

- AWS account with admin privileges
 - At least one **running EC2 instance**
 - Permissions:
 - `ComputeOptimizerFullAccess`
 - `CloudWatchReadOnlyAccess`
 - `ec2:DescribeInstances`
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Lab Structure

1. Enable AWS Compute Optimizer
2. Launch a test EC2 instance (if not already running)
3. Wait for data collection (minimum 12–24 hours)
4. View optimization recommendations

5. Analyze suggestions and take action

Step 1: Enable AWS Compute Optimizer

1. Go to: <https://console.aws.amazon.com/compute-optimizer>
2. If first time:
 - Click "**Get started**"
 - Choose:
 - ☒ **EC2 Instances**
 - ☒ **EBS Volumes**
 - ☒ **Auto Scaling Groups** *(optional)*
 - ☒ **Lambda Functions** *(optional)*
3. Click **Enable**

 **Note:** Data collection takes ~12–24 hours before recommendations show up.

Step 2: Launch a Test EC2 Instance (if needed)

If you don't already have EC2 running:

1. Go to **EC2 Console**
2. Launch an EC2 instance with:
 - AMI: Amazon Linux 2
 - Type: **t2.medium**

- Name: `ComputeOptimizerTest`
- Leave it running idle or under light load

Let it run for a **few hours to days** to gather usage data.

Step 3: View Recommendations

1. Go to **AWS Compute Optimizer Console**
2. In the sidebar, select:
 - **EC2 Instance Recommendations**
 - **EBS Volume Recommendations**
3. For each resource, review:

Field	Description
Current Instance Type	e.g., <code>t2.medium</code>
Recommended Type	e.g., <code>t3.small</code>
Performance Risk	Low, Medium, or High
Savings Opportunity	Monthly cost savings
Utilization Metrics	CPU, Memory, Network

Step 4: Take Action (Manual Optimization)

If you agree with the recommendation:

Option 1: Resize EC2 instance

1. Stop the instance

2. Change instance type (e.g., from `t2.medium` to `t3.small`)
3. Start the instance again

Option 2: Change EBS Volume Type

1. Go to **EBS Console**
2. Modify volume → choose recommended volume type (e.g., gp2 → gp3)

(Optional) Step 5: Use AWS CLI to Get Recommendations

```
aws compute-optimizer get-ec2-instance-recommendations \
  --region us-east-1 \
  --query "instanceRecommendations[*].{InstanceId:instanceId, Current:currentInstanceType,
Recommend:recommendationOptions[0].instanceType,
Risk:recommendationOptions[0].performanceRisk}"
```

Summary

Task	Completed
Enabled Compute Optimizer	
Launched EC2 (if needed)	
Waited for usage data	
Reviewed recommendations	
Took optimization action	

Cleanup

- Stop or terminate the test EC2 instance (if created for the lab)
 - Modify EBS volumes back if needed
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